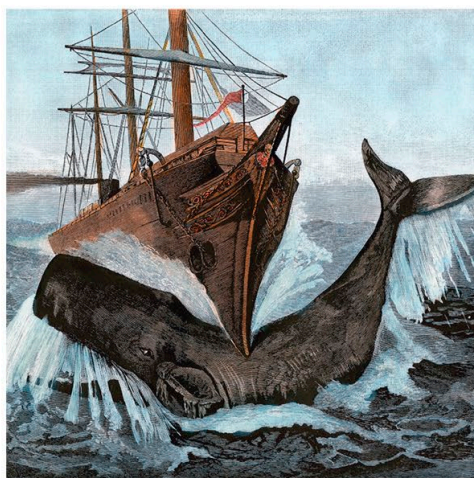


1820 SINKING OF THE WHALER ESSEX

A sperm whale rammed the US whaler *Essex* in the Pacific Ocean, crushing the ship's bow. The crew abandoned ship and attempted to reach land in three small boats. After three months at sea, having endured storms and been forced into cannibalism, only five men survived. The story inspired the American novel *Moby Dick*.

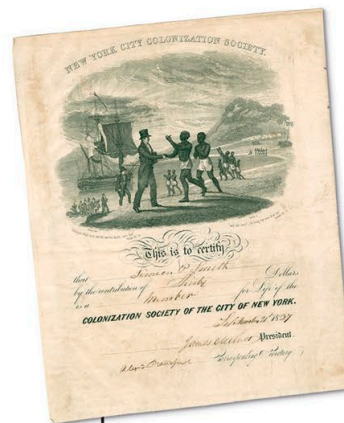


△ A whale rams the Essex

1820

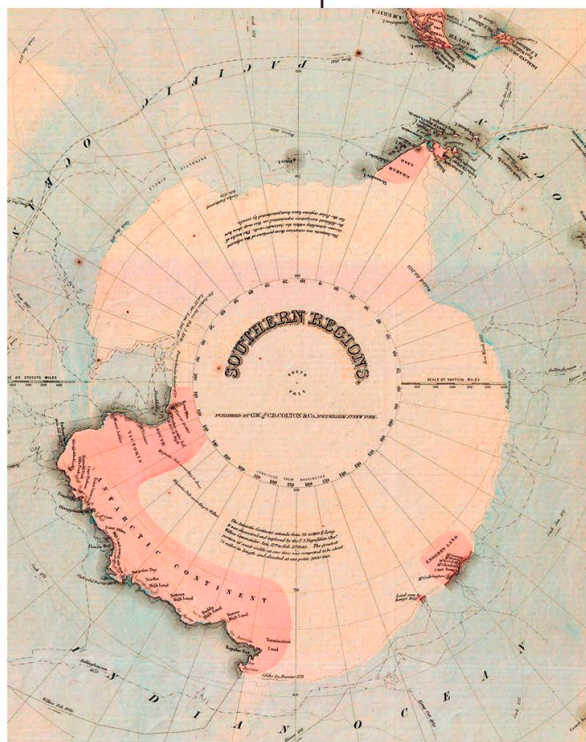
COLONY OF LIBERIA FOUNDED

In 1820, the white American Colonization Society began sending volunteers from among America's formerly enslaved people to establish a colony on West Africa's Pepper Coast. Nearly half the first settlers died; more arrived and the colony declared independence in 1847.



△ Colonization Society membership certificate

1820



△ Colton's map of the South Pole, 1872

1820

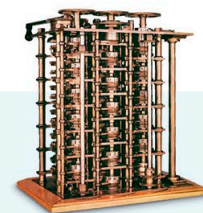
FIRST RECORDED SIGHTING OF ANTARCTICA

The ancient Greeks postulated the idea of a southern land mass and, in 1773, Captain James Cook unknowingly crossed the Antarctic Circle. The first sighting of Antarctica, however, was by the Russian explorer Thaddeus von Bellingshausen, who saw the ice-fields of the Antarctic coast on 28 January 1820. Two days later, Irishman Edward Bransfield sighted the northernmost point of the Antarctic mainland.

1821 Mexico becomes a sovereign country, but Spain does not recognize its independence until 1836

1822-1943 EARLY COMPUTING

Developments in computer theory in the 19th century laid the foundations for modern computing, paving the way for the earliest digital machines in the 20th century.



1822 Charles Babbage, an English inventor, designs a "Difference Engine" – a steam-driven calculating machine, arguably the first computer.